animal that the prophet Muhammad rode to heaven on his night journey (Miraj). From at least the fifteenth century, Persian paintings showed Buraq with a horse's body, wings, and a woman's face; the peacock tail may have been an Indian addition. Popular portrayals of Kamadhenu in India today often show her in this Indo-Persian composite form; this may be one of the earliest images to merge the visual characteristics of the Hindu Kamadhenu with the Islamic Buraq.'

2 Sir W. W. Hunter, 'The Religions of India', *The Times*, 25 February 1888.

3 Sir Henry Elliot, *The History of India, as told by its own historians*, Vol. 2, 1870.

4 *The Travels of Ibn Batutah*, ed. Tim Mackintosh-Smith. It has been argued that the real name of the mountain range that divides Afghanistan is the Hindu Koh, or 'mountains of India', derived from the time when Brahminism and Buddhism flourished in what was then Indian Gandhara, and that Hindu Kush is a corruption. But that misses the point, which is that by Ibn Battuta's time the main pass over the Hindu Koh had become known as the Hindu Kush, a trail of tears for the hundreds of thousands of enslaved Indians transported over it.

5 Koran 47:4.

6 See, for example, Scott C. Levi, 'Hindus beyond the Hindu Kush: Indians in the central Asian slave trade', *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society*, Vol. 12 (3), Nov. 2002. The Slave Dynasty took its name from the fact that its founder, Qutub-ud-Din Aibak, was a Turkic slave who rose to become military commander under Mahmud of Ghori.

7 Bearing in mind that under *zakat*, the fifth pillar of Islam, it was also obligatory on all Muslims to give alms according to their wealth. But of course one requirement was compulsory, the other rarely enforced.